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WaTech
Washington Technology Solutions

Replaces:
EA183.20.10 (4.1.1)
July 10, 2008
EA185.10
June 6, 2016

WORKFORCE IDENTITY AND ACCESS ENTERPRISE SERVICE STANDARD

See Also:
RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance; (2) "electronic information sharing and access"
RCW 43.105.020 Definitions
RCW 43.105.265 (1) Enterprise Strategy
RCW 43.105.450 (3)(a) "establish security standards and policies to protect the state's information technology systems and infrastructure"

1. PURPOSE

This standard establishes the statewide service capability, Workforce Identity and Access, as an enterprise service under EA-02 – Establishing an Enterprise Service Policy. A Washington state agency must not adopt a service with similar capabilities unless it has an approved waiver or exemption (see Section 5).

2. SCOPE

1. Workforce Identity and Access must be used for authentication and authorization of workforce identities across all platforms and hosting models.
2. The scope of this standard does not include anonymous or public-facing systems with no workforce identity.

3. APPLICABILITY

1. This standard applies to all Washington State agencies and their organizational users, including employees, contractors, partners, and vendors accessing internal state resources.

4. ENTERPRISE SERVICE CAPABILITIES

The Workforce Identity and Access enterprise service designation encompasses the following capabilities:

1. Centralized Workforce Authentication and Authorization – provides a shared, enterprise-managed directory service for workforce identities and devices, enabling consistent authentication and authorization across on-premises, cloud, and hybrid environments. Supports role-based access, group-based controls, and policy-driven enforcement.
2. Federated Identity and Single Sign-On (SSO) – enables secure single sign-on for workforce users by federating enterprise identity credentials to trusted internal,

cloud, and partner applications. Reduces credential sprawl while enforcing enterprise authentication policies across service boundaries.

3. Cloud-Based Identity and Access Management – delivers centralized, cloud-enabled identity services that manage workforce access to applications and resources regardless of hosting model. Supports modern authentication, conditional access, multi-factor authentication, and lifecycle management aligned with zero trust principles.
4. Hybrid Directory Extension for Cloud Workloads – extends enterprise directory and authentication services into cloud environments to support workloads that require domain-based identity, policy enforcement, and device authentication. Enables consistent identity controls for cloud-hosted infrastructure while maintaining enterprise governance.
5. Delegated Administration and Operational Governance – provides delegated, role-based administrative capabilities that allow agencies to manage workforce identities within enterprise-defined guardrails. Supports visibility, auditing, and standardized operational controls while preserving centralized governance and compliance.

5. WAIVERS AND EXEMPTIONS TO THIS STANDARD

In accordance with POL-01-02-S Technology Policy and Standard Waiver Request Standard, agencies may qualify for a waiver or exemption from compliance with this standard. Agencies may request an exemption for situations that meet one of the following criteria:

1. Privileged or Bootstrap Accounts that are used only for recovery or provisioning.
2. Legacy or Air-Gapped Systems including:
    a. State-owned legacy systems lacking modern identity integration capabilities (e.g., mainframe systems without Single Sign-On (SSO) interfaces).
    b. Air-gapped or out-of-band managed systems where integration is technically infeasible.

    Legacy or Air-Gapped Systems must adhere to security requirements, including SEC-04-08-S Unsupported Technology Retirement.
3. Temporary use or proof-of-concept (POC) applications with all of the following attributes:
    a. Duration of less than six months
    b. Non-production environment and data (this exemption will not carry over to production deployment)
4. Accessibility and Accommodation Tools, such as applications required for accessibility or reasonable accommodation (e.g., screen readers or text-to-speech tools) that do not support enterprise SSO.

5. Vendor-Managed SaaS Applications with limited scope and all of the following attributes:
    a. Serve fewer than 10 users with no opportunity to grow beyond 25 users in the future
    b. Do not integrate with any other systems
    c. Handle only Category 1 or Category 2 data
    d. Are not used to support mission-critical or business-essential functions
6. Legal or Regulatory Systems, including federal or external systems requiring mandated credentials, or that do not support Security Assertion Markup Language (SAML) or OpenID Connect (OIDC) integrations.
7. Multi-jurisdictional, regional, or community collaborations that require use of their own authentication.

REFERENCES

1. Service Catalog Page: Workforce Identity and Access
2. Definition of Terms Used in Policies and Reports
3. MGMT-01-01-S – Technology Portfolio Foundation – Application Standard
4. POL-01-01-PR – Technology Policies and Standards Waiver Procedure
5. POL-01-02-S – Technology Policy and Standard Waiver Request Standard
6. SEC-02-01-S – Application Security Standard
7. SEC-04-08-S – Unsupported Technology Retirement
8. SEC-06 – Access Control Policy
9. SEC-06-01-S – Identification and Authentication Security Standard
10. SEC-11-01-S – Risk Assessment Standard

CONTACT INFORMATION

For questions about this standard, contact the WaTech policy mailbox.